big sword with an attendant behind her. She is perhaps ‘one of the *Mahatalvaris* [sword-wielding women] mentioned in the inscriptions’.[12]

We see Brahminical temples dedicated to gods like Shiva, Karttikeya, Devasena, Kubera and Vishnu. Many of these temples are inside large complexes with additional shrines, pavilions and residential quarters, where the attendant priests or servants live. Temples mostly have flat stone slabs for roofs, laid over stone or wooden beams resting on pillars and occasionally a barrel-vaulted top. They are inscribed in Sanskrit, while the surrounding Buddhist monuments are inscribed in Prakrit. Among the largest and most majestic temples is Sarvadeva, ‘abode of all gods’, with its pillared hall (later destroyed by fire). The temple is next to a large stepped masonry tank used for ceremonies, with its own pillared pavilion overlooking the river.

In general, the Brahminical sites are all near the riverfront, while Buddhist sites are more spread out across the entire valley of Vijayapuri, often near the city’s major arteries. Buddhist sites also outnumber Brahminical ones, though the gap reduced after the third king. Besides these two belief systems, a cult of the mother goddess, suggesting fertility, sexuality and creation, is all the rage. Popular terracotta figurines depict her in a squatting pose or lying on her back, indicating either a birthing posture or readiness for sex. She is likely the non-Brahminical deity later known as Lajja Gauri, popular in central India and the Deccan. Just north of the citadel, by the river, stands a temple dedicated to her.